Chapter 7 - Taxation and Finances of Minnetonka's Home Rule Charter shall be amended to include the following language:

Section 7.19. Limitation on Annual Property Tax Levy Increases.

(a) Structural Limit. The City Council shall not adopt a total property tax levy for any fiscal year that exceeds the previous year's total property tax levy by more than 6.0%.

(b) Voter Approval for Excess. The power of the City Council to levy taxes in exceedance of the limit in subsection (a) is contingent upon ratification by a majority of the voters of the City voting on the question at a general or special election.

(c) Exclusions. This limitation shall not apply to:

1. **Debt Service:** Levies for the payment of principal and interest on voter-approved municipal bonds;
2. **City Judgments:** Levies required to pay court-ordered judgments or legally binding settlements; or
3. **Emergency Power:** Levies required to address a state-declared or locally declared emergency only as permitted under Minnesota Statutes.

(d) Procedural Integrity.

1. **Truth in Taxation Compliance:** No preliminary levy exceeding the limit in subsection (a) shall be deemed validly certified unless designated as conditional and subject to a pending referendum on the Notice of Proposed Property Taxes. The City shall utilize the notification procedures of Minnesota Statute § 275.065 to ensure the electorate is informed of the conditional nature of the proposed tax increase.
2. **Assessment Integrity:** The City Council shall not alter its method or ratio of funding infrastructure projects in a manner that shifts costs traditionally borne by the general levy into special assessments for the purpose of circumventing these structural limits.

(e) Severability. The provisions of this Section are severable. If any part is held invalid or unconstitutional, such invalidity shall not affect the remaining portions.

(f) Effective Date. This Section shall be effective for all property tax levies certified by the City after January 1st of the year following the adoption of this amendment by the voters.

(g) Conflict with Other Sections. In the event of any inconsistency or conflict between the provisions of this Section and any other provision of this Charter—including but not limited to sections governing budget preparation, adoption, or emergency appropriations—the provisions of this Section shall prevail and control.